

2 CHRONICLES XVIII. XIX. XX.

29 And the king of Israel said unto Jehoshaphat, I will disguise myself, and enter into the battle; but do thou put on thy royal garments. And the king of Israel disguised himself, and they went into the battle.

30 And the king of Syria had commanded the captains of the chariots that he had, saying, Fight ye not with the small or with the great, save only with the king of Israel alone.

31 And it came to pass, when the captains of the chariots saw Jehoshaphat, that they said, This is the king of Israel. And they encompassed him to fight; and Jehoshaphat cried out, and the LORD helped him; and God induced them to go away from him.

32 And it came to pass, when the captains of the chariots perceived that it was not the king of Israel, that they turned back from following him.

33 But a certain man drew his bow at a venture, and struck the king of Israel between the joints and the armour: wherefore he said to the chariot-driver, Turn about, and carry me out of the camp; for I am wounded.

34 And the battle increased on that day: and the king of Israel stayed (himself) up in the chariot against the Syrians until the evening, and he died at the time of the sun's going down.

CHAPTER XIX.

1 ¶ And Jehoshaphat the king of Judah returned to his house in peace, to Jerusalem.

2 And there came out to meet him Jehu the son of Chanani the seër, and said to king Jehoshaphat, Shouldst thou help the wicked, and love those that hate the LORD? and because of this there is wrath over thee from before the LORD.

3 Nevertheless there are good things found on thee; because thou hast removed the Asheroth out of the land, and hast directed thy heart firmly to seek God.

4 ¶ And Jehoshaphat remained at Jerusalem; but he went out again through the people from Beër-sheba' as far as the mountain of Ephraim, and caused them to return unto the LORD the God of their fathers.

5 And he appointed judges in the land in all the fortified cities of Judah, in city by city.

6 And he said to the judges, Look (well)

at what ye are doing; because not for man are ye to judge, but for the LORD, who is with you in pronouncing judgment.

7 And now let the dread of the LORD be upon you: take heed and act; for with the LORD our God there is no injustice, nor respect for persons, nor taking of bribes.

8 But also in Jerusalem did Jehoshaphat appoint some of the Levites, and the priests, and of the chiefs of the family divisions of Israel, for the (giving of) the judgment of the LORD, and for controversies, when they returned to Jerusalem.

9 And he charged on them, saying, Thus shall ye do in the fear of the LORD, in faithfulness, and with an undivided heart.

10 And whatsoever controversy may come to you from your brethren that dwell in their cities, between blood and blood, between law and commandment, statutes and ordinances, ye shall truly warn them that they incur not guilt against the LORD, and so there come wrath over you, and over your brethren: so must ye do, and ye will not incur guilt.

11 And, behold, Amaryahu the chief priest is over you for every matter of the LORD; and Zebadyahu the son of Yishma'el, the ruler for the house of Judah, for every matter of the king; and the Levites are officers before you. Be strong and act, and may the LORD be with the good.

CHAPTER XX.

1 ¶ And it came to pass after this, that the children of Mo'ab, and the children of 'Ammon, and with them some of the 'Ammonim,* came against Jehoshaphat to battle.

2 And there came some and told unto Jehoshaphat, saying, There is coming against thee a great multitude from beyond the sea, from Syria; and, behold, they are in Chazon-thamar, which is 'En-gedi.

3 Then became Jehoshaphat afraid, and he directed his face to seek the LORD; and he proclaimed a fast over all Judah.

4 And (the people of) Judah gathered themselves together, to ask (help) of the LORD: also out of all the cities of Judah did they come to seek the LORD.

* Some suppose this to mean "the Me'unim," the inhabitants of Arabia Petraea.